

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, mostly sunny, less humid, some air quality improvement, high 82. **Tonight**, a clear sky, low 65. **To-morrow**, sunny to partly cloudy, high 82. Weather map is on Page 20.

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Prices in Canada may be higher

\$6.00

Trump Enlists Spy Agencies In ’20 Grudge

Federal Push to Revive Voting-Fraud Claims

This article is by **Zolan Kanno-Youngs, Nick Corasaniti and Dustin Volz**.

When President Trump tried to undermine and overturn the election results in 2020, he ran into stiff pushback — not just in the courts, but from many officials in his own government.

He made sure there would be little room for such dissent when he returned to the White House. Those seeking to join Mr. Trump’s second administration had to pass a key litmus test: Did they believe the 2020 election was stolen from Mr. Trump?

With like-minded allies now positioned in key roles throughout the government, Mr. Trump has trained the full arsenal of the federal government on one of his most persistent obsessions: sowing doubt about the security of the country’s election systems.

Major agencies such as the Justice Department, the F.B.I., the Homeland Security Department and the U.S. Postal Service have taken steps to revive his false claims about the 2020 election and try to assert federal control over state-run elections.

His efforts got additional reinforcements on Thursday from the country’s intelligence agencies, which provided the White House with a trove of declassified evidence that Mr. Trump held up as evidence of a broken election system.

“Tonight, I’m announcing the immediate declassification and release of critical intelligence, revealing shocking vulnerabilities in our election infrastructure,” the president said in a prime-time speech from the East Room.

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FABIOLA FERRERO FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Rushing to Help in Venezuela

Volunteers descended on the coastal city of La Guaira after the twin earthquakes in June. Page 12.

IRAN STRIKE KILLS TWO U.S. TROOPS

1st Combat Deaths Since End of Cease-Fire

This article is by **John Ismay, Aaron Boxerman and Leily Nikounazar**.

WASHINGTON — Two U.S. soldiers were killed in an Iranian attack on a base in Jordan on Friday, the U.S. military said, the first American troops to die from hostile fire since Tehran and Washington ended their cease-fire a week ago.

A third service member was missing after the missile attack, according to a statement on Saturday from U.S. Central Command, which oversees operations in the region. Four American service members wounded in the attack were taken to Jordanian hospitals and discharged.

The U.S. military retaliated swiftly, beginning a new round of attacks in Iran at about 1:30 a.m. local time on Sunday, according to Central Command. The new strikes came on top of an already worsening conflict. Both countries have been expanding the scope and intensity of their attacks, striking military sites and infrastructure including a power station and water facilities.

Iranian state media on Saturday reported damage to bridges and roads in the south of Iran, and that a water desalination plant in Jask, a strategic port city, had been hit, citing a local official as saying that about 10,000 people were facing water shortages. The U.S. military did not respond to a request for comment on those reports.

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A Compelling Distraction at the Perfect Time

I’m not a sports guy. That is not to say I’m a sports *hater* — I’ll watch the occasional tennis final and Olympics curling match and the Michigan-Ohio State game in November. But I don’t have the bandwidth to truly follow any sport. The athlete cam

JAMES PONIEWOZIK
CRITIC’S NOTEBOOK

eo in Super Bowl ads sail over my head. In my LearnedLeague trivia matches, the questions about Premier League soccer — there are more of them than you might think — always spell my doom.

But the summer of 2026 has done strange things to the least

World Cup Provided an Abundance of Good Vibes

sportsy among us. If you live in New York, as I do, you may have spent a lot of time rewatching the Knicks’ OG Anunoby reaching for that N.B.A. finals tip-in like Michelangelo’s God giving life to Adam, reminding us that we could actually have good things.

Then the World Cup came ashore in North America and, lo, we had the show of the summer. The broadcasts are pulling football ratings — sorry, *American*

football ratings — and setting records even in games not involving the U.S. team. This summer has felt as if the whole tense world were exhaling and taking a collective play break.

I can resist sports, but I can’t resist vibes. I started dipping into matches in the group stage. (Also, I learned what a “group stage” is.) I read up on Cape Verde and became willing to lay down my life for that country.

Now I am that guy, glued to

Continued on Page 26

WHO IS SPANISH? Lamine Yamal, a 19-year-old soccer star, is at the heart of a debate about multiculturalism in Spain. PAGE 24



VINCENT ALBAN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES, LEFT AND CENTER; GABRIEL BHASKAR/THE NEW YORK TIMES, RIGHT

The World Cup spectacle stretched far beyond the field. A fan from Ecuador showed his true colors, left; the Norwegians did their “Viking Row,” center; and U.S. fans were ready to mix it up.

Charges of Assaulting ICE Unravel From Misconduct

Nearly Half of Resolved Cases Have Been Dismissed, Defeated or Withdrawn

This article is by **Mike McIntire, Danny Hakim, Alexandra Berzon, Jazmine Ulloa and Lauren McCarthy**.

In its nationwide immigration crackdown, the Trump administration has charged hundreds of people with assaulting or impeding federal agents. President Trump has branded them “insurrectionists,” “animals” and “thugs,” part of a broader effort by his administration to cast protesters and immigrants as violent criminals.

But a close examination of those cases reveals that in its rush to meet White House demands for deportations, federal law enforcement has engaged in extensive misconduct — ranging from attacking protesters to destroying evidence and misrepresenting facts in court.

The New York Times found that the Trump administration has filed assault charges against more than 550 people who were caught in its immigration dragnet — far more than previously known. Of the more than 400 cases resolved so far, nearly half have unraveled: Juries acquitted defendants, judges threw out charges, or prosecutors withdrew them.

The record is abysmal by the typical standards of federal prosecutions: The Justice Department seldom loses criminal cases, with more than 90 percent of defendants pleading guilty or being convicted at trial.

The Times obtained court filings for every assault case and reviewed hearing transcripts, interviewed witnesses and federal officials and watched videos of dozens of encounters that led to criminal charges. The review, the most comprehensive to date, sug-

gests that the administration’s use of the law has often been less about protecting federal agents than about providing legal cover to cow protesters and immigrants into submission.

“There seems to be a pattern of charges being filed without any merit,” said Jimmy L. Arce, a former federal prosecutor in Chicago who served on a commission that investigated immigration raids in the city last year. He added that some defendants were “having their speech criminalized by the U.S. attorney’s office.”

Earlier this year, the Trump administration dialed back some of its most confrontational tactics, leading to fewer assault charges. But it recently began an aggressive new wave of enforcement, with agents killing two immigrants in Texas and Maine. With hundreds of cases resolved, it is now possible to more fully assess the administration’s conduct and results.

In the half of assault cases that ended in the government’s favor, almost all were guilty pleas. The Times’s analysis of the 213 cases that the government has lost or abandoned found that in dozens of cases, court records and videos show that federal agents were the first to get physical — shoving, tackling or pepper-spraying defendants. Many defendants successfully argued that the assaults they were accused of were actually acts of self-defense.

Judges repeatedly chastised

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MAINE SHOOTING An ICE agent told his former wife that he killed an immigrant last week, and he defended his actions. PAGE 17

A Renaissance of Start-Ups By Americans, With A.I.’s Help

By **SYDNEY EMBER**

Cassidy Winkler was working as a flight attendant on private jets when inspiration struck.

It was the offseason for the professional hockey players she helped ferry around, and things at her job were slow. Eager for a diversion and missing the Pilates she had come to love as a college student, she went searching for studios near her home in Madison, Wis., but couldn’t find any.

“That’s when I came up with the idea,” she said.

She started researching how to start her own boutique Pilates business, including what kind of training instructors would need. By early 2025 — and with assistance from chatbots including ChatGPT — she had come up with a name, Revel Method Pilates, a logo and a plan.

Soon, Ms. Winkler, 26, had opened studios in Lake Geneva, Madison and Monona. She now has 65 employees and is set to unveil a fourth studio this year.

Across the country, founders like Ms. Winkler are powering an entrepreneurial renaissance.

Jump-started by the pandemic, when a confluence of factors including mass layoffs and remote work led to a flood of business creation, and supercharged by the rise of artificial intelligence, start-up activity is booming after a decades-long slump.

Americans filed 5.7 million applications last year to start new businesses, according to the Census Bureau, the most in the two decades the government has kept track. New business applications through the first half of this year continued to climb.

The strong run of business creation is one of the most surprising



KAYLA WOLF FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Cassidy Winkler, 26, said she used A.I. to develop marketing for her Pilates business.

and welcome economic developments of the post-pandemic era. New businesses help drive innovation and productivity growth. Although many fail or remain small, some could develop into giants that spur job growth for years to come.

“The sustained high rate of both main street and growth-oriented entrepreneurship over the past five years is a piece of super good news about the future of the economy,” said Scott Stern, an economist at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology.

Data on the number of business formed each year lags, so it will take time to determine whether the increase in new business applications translates to a rise in real-world businesses and hiring. In 2023, the most recent year for which the data is available, half a

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INTERNATIONAL 4-13

Envoy to Italy Cruises the Sea

While leaders feud, the U.S. ambassador to Rome is on a monthslong trip on his \$450 million superyacht. PAGE 10

Youth Movement in Ukraine

A new generation has been cutting red tape to speed weapons to the front. But the old guard has pushed back. PAGE 4



SPORTS 24-28

Fewer Deadline Blockbusters

Citing an increased reliance on analytics, officials from teams throughout the major leagues tempered expectations for big trades at the deadline. PAGE 27

NATIONAL 14-23

Small Tribes Lacking Clout

Bands like the Chinook Indian Nation do not have the political muscle to secure federal recognition. PAGE 14

Recall Expands to 27 States

Iceberg lettuce that Taylor Farms shipped to retailers was potentially contaminated with cyclospora. PAGE 21

METROPOLITAN

Paid \$18 an Hour to Save Lives

Some emergency workers are finding it hard to afford living in New York City on the salaries they make, a plight that has led to seeking other jobs. PAGE 1



SUNDAY OPINION

Andrea R. Flores

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SUNDAY BUSINESS

Nike in the Cross Hairs

The company was well known for its diversity efforts. That made it a target for the Trump administration. PAGE 1

A Vicious Rivalry? You Bet.

Shayne Coplan of Polymarket and Tarek Mansour of Kalshi are intent on dominating prediction markets. PAGE 6

SUNDAY STYLES

Welding vs. College Degree

Gen Z is increasingly turning to trade schools in hopes of future-proofing their careers against A.I. But their parents might need more convincing. PAGE 4

ARTS & LEISURE

Gracie Abrams Looks Around

On her new album, the singer explores where she came from and the disorienting place she has ended up. PAGE 8

